Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 10:30 a.m. on March 8, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	L. Bower
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
	Mayor	S. Collier (exited at 3:01 p.m.)

1. Call to Order

Chair Bower called the meeting to order at 10:30 a.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

Strategic Planning Mid-Term Update Workshop (10:30 a.m.)

3. Presentation

3.1 CAO-2021-02: 2018-2022 Strategic Plan Mid-Term Update

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, delivered a presentation regarding the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan Mid-Term. C. McLardie discussed impacts of COVID-19 on the Strategic Plan process, mid-term factors and influences including budget constraints, new projects, evolving priorities and synergies between actions. C. McLardie discussed the framework for the Strategic Plan, recommendations, current status of action items, and major accomplishments.

C. McLardie led Committee Members through a discussion of the status and proposed changes of the 3 focus areas in the Strategic Plan.

Focus Area: Connecting our Community

Committee Members asked questions regarding opportunities to enhance and promote tourism at the Ajax Waterfront and Greenwood, engagement with Community Champions,

public interest in the In My Opinion (IMO) platform, ISO designation status, timeline for completion of the Recreation Master Plan, live streaming technology to broadcast Council and Committee meetings, and justifications for mergers and deferrals of action items. C. McLardie, Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, and Chris Vida, Acting Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Focus Area: Investing in our Community

Committee Members asked questions regarding improving the Town's Senior Snow Removal Program, web content published with respect to the 2020-2025 Economic Development Action Plan, and timelines associated with the Economic Development Round Table motion and Priority Path Program. Committee Members asked further questions regarding waste management practices, funding options to accelerate the Automated Speed Enforcement program, operational and capital costs for new infrastructure, development applications and dog park initiatives. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, C. McLardie, Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, and S. Baker responded to questions from Committee Members.

Focus Area: Leading in our Community

Committee Members asked questions regarding security assessment of parks, private security contracts, investment of cannabis retail provincial funds, and costs associated with security and lighting enhancements. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

C. McLardie concluded her presentation with an overall assessment and discussed next steps in the Strategic Planning process.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the development of a motion tracker. C. McLardie and Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: A. Khan

That the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan Mid-Term Update be endorsed by Council, and all proposed revisions described in this report be incorporated into the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan.

CARRIED

Committee recessed at 12:45 p.m.

Committee resumed at 1:01 p.m.

4. Adoption of Minutes

4.1 Capital & Operating Budget Meeting

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the Capital & Operating Budget meeting of the General Government Committee held on February 8, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4.2 **Regular Meeting**

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on February 16, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4.3 **Closed Session**

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on February 16, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

5. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 5.3 and 5.4 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That items 5.1 and 5.2 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

5.1 **FIN-2021-01: 2020 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees**

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2020 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees be received for information.

CARRIED

5.2 **PDS-2021-03: 2020 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2021 Projection Report**

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2020 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2021 Projection Report be received for information.

CARRIED

5.3 **PDS-2021-10: Parking License Agreement at Ajax Community Centre**

Committee Members asked questions regarding temporary parking lot locations,

substitute material for gravel, impacts of lighting on nearby properties, anticipated timelines for closure of outdoor amenities and project completion, and relocation site for smaller trees. Nadia Sukovski, Senior Economic Development Officer, G. Romanowski, and D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That the Town Solicitor be directed to draft Parking License Agreements with PCL Constructors Canada Inc. and Lakeridge Health to permit the construction, use and subsequent restoration of temporary parking lots at the Ajax Community Centre, to accommodate parking needs associated with the construction of the Long Term Care Facility and parking garage at Lakeridge Health Ajax-Pickering Hospital; and

2. That Mayor and Clerk be directed to execute Parking License Agreements with PCL Constructors Canada Inc. and Lakeridge Health, provided that the agreements include the key conditions outlined within this report and have been approved by the Town Solicitor and the Director of Planning & Development Services.

CARRIED

5.4 **2020 Annual Report of the Integrity Commissioner**

Committee Members asked questions regarding breakdown of costs attributed to the Integrity Commissioner and the Ombudsman. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the 2020 Annual Report of the Integrity Commissioner be received for information.

CARRIED

6. Discussion

6.1 **PDS-2021-11: Renaming of Langsdorff Drive**

Committee Members asked questions regarding the Town's street-naming policy, residual names without a street name dedication for those who served during the Battle of the River Plate, and future plans for the existing plaque at Langsdorff Drive. G. Romanowski responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That staff be directed to proceed with changing the name of Langsdorff Drive to Croker Drive, and notify all residents accordingly.

CARRIED

6.2 **PDS-2021-08: Review of Harwood Avenue and Fishlock Street Intersection**

Committee Members asked questions regarding costs associated with warranted traffic signals and the process with the Region of Durham. John Grieve, Transportation Supervisor, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Review of the Harwood Avenue and Fishlock Street Intersection be referred back to staff with direction to complete a new review and traffic count once provincial COIVD-19 restrictions have been lifted for the Town of Ajax, or by spring of 2022 at the latest.

CARRIED

7. Presentations

7.1 PDS-2021-04: Designation of the Nicholas Austin Property under Part IV of the Ontario Heritage Act

Michael Sawchuck, Senior Planner, delivered a presentation regarding the designation of the Nicholas Austin Property. M. Sawchuck provided a description of the property and explained why the property is being considered for heritage designation. M. Sawchuck discussed property complaints, property standards, heritage value, consultations, heritage designation process, designation myths, and recommendations.

Committee Members asked questions regarding efforts to contact the property owner, next steps after heritage designation, and remedies available to the Town to ensure the property is maintained. M. Sawchuck responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: A. Khan

1. That the Nicholas Austin Property (775 Kingston Road East) be designated by the Town of Ajax as a property of cultural heritage value or interest under Section 29 (Part IV) of the *Ontario Heritage Act*, R.S.O. 1990, C.O. 18; and

2. That staff be authorized to issue the required notices and prepare the designation by-law for consideration by Council.

CARRIED

7.2 PDS-2021-07: 2020 Transportation Awareness Campaign #GetAjaxMoving Update

Armi de Francia, Active Transportation Coordinator, delivered a presentation and provided updates on the transportation awareness campaign #GetAjaxMoving. A. de Francia discussed benefits of sustainable transportation modes, COVID-19 trends, motivational interviewing, engaging seniors, bike repair stations, online educational resources, trails in Ajax, webpage updates, campaign results and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the driver awareness campaign, safe driving strategies, e-bike regulations, congestion solutions to accommodate biking and walking traffic, and insufficient number of bike racks. A. de Francia and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the report entitled “2020 #GetAjaxMoving – Transportation Awareness Campaign Update” be received for information.

CARRIED

7.3 PDS-2021-05: Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update

Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change, provided an update on projects and programs within the Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change portfolio. C. Richardson discussed the Ajax Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan, 2019 (ACRRP) including invasive species awareness, emergency preparedness and response, and wetland creation and restoration. C. Richardson discussed energy, Zero Emission Vehicle Program, green development and environmental design guidelines, single use plastics ban, and Canada Target 1.

Committee Members asked questions regarding phragmites invasion and control, emergency preparedness materials, reduction of gas powered plants, greenhouse gas emissions reduction, carbon reduction targets, carbon measuring methods and opportunities to implement a textile diversion program. C. Richardson responded to questions from Committee Members.

Councillor Bower vacated the Chair. Councillor Tyler Morin assumed the Chair.

Main Motion

Moved by: A. Khan

That the report on Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update be received for information.

Amendment

Moved by: L. Bower

That the motion be amended by adding the following provision:

That staff be directed to further investigate options to implement a textile diversion program in the Town of Ajax and report back to Council or the appropriate standing committee by May of 2021 with considerations and recommendations on such a program.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: A. Khan

That the report on Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update be received for information; and

That staff be directed to further investigate options to implement a textile diversion program in the Town of Ajax and report back to Council or the appropriate standing

committee by May of 2021 with considerations and recommendations on such a program.
CARRIED

Councillor Bower resumed the Chair.

7.4 **PDS-2021-06: CLOCA Shoreline Hazard Management Plan**

Stephen Ruddy, Acting Manager of Development Engineering, introduced Perry Sisson, Director of Engineering and Field Operations, and Chris Jones, Director of Planning and Regulations, Central Lake Ontario Conservation Authority (CLOCA). P. Sisson and C. Jones delivered a presentation regarding the CLOCA Shoreline Hazard Management Plan. P. Sisson discussed shoreline inventory, shoreline structures and condition, analysis of long shore sediment drift, computation and mapping of the 100 year flood hazard, the 100 year erosion limit, damage centres and possible mitigation, reach by reach analysis, higher 100 year flood elevation, erosion rates, climate change and impacts on the Ajax shoreline. C. Jones reviewed reach by reach findings and recommendations, and implementation of the CLOCA Shoreline Hazard Management Plan.

Committee Members asked questions regarding beach maintenance, shoreline erosion, opportunities for CLOCA to collaborate with the Town on developing an emergency management plan, emergency response management and shoreline stabilization methods to support residents. P. Sission, C. Jones and D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That this report titled, CLOCA Shoreline Hazard Management Plan, be received for information.

CARRIED

8. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

8.1 **Ajax Fire Association Grievance**

Councillor Bower noted that the report and recommendations were withdrawn.

9. **Adjournment** (3:48 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the March 8, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.
CARRIED